Commercial Revenue & Sales Intelligence

Executive Sales Performance Analysis

SQL | Microsoft Advanced Excel | Business Intelligence | Commercial Analytics | Executive Reporting

Portfolio Project

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About This Project

This project demonstrates how structured sales data can be transformed into actionable business intelligence using **SQL** and **Microsoft Advanced Excel**. It showcases the complete analytical lifecycle—from extracting transactional data from a relational database, through data preparation and modelling, to executive dashboard development and strategic business reporting.

Rather than simply presenting charts and key performance indicators, this analysis focuses on solving real commercial challenges faced by business leaders. The project applies analytical thinking, financial reasoning, and business intelligence techniques to identify revenue drivers, evaluate commercial performance, uncover operational inefficiencies, and recommend practical strategies that support sustainable business growth.

The outcome is an executive-level sales intelligence solution designed to assist management in making evidence-based decisions regarding customer strategy, sales performance, regional expansion, inventory planning, logistics optimisation, and profitability improvement.

Executive Summary

Commercial organisations generate significant volumes of transactional sales data every day. However, data alone does not create business value. Organisations gain a competitive advantage only when that data is transformed into meaningful insights that support strategic decision-making.

This project analyses **Frangle's 2014 commercial sales performance** using **Microsoft SQL Server** for data extraction and **Microsoft Advanced Excel** for data preparation, analysis, dashboard development, and executive reporting. The objective was to convert raw transactional data into practical business intelligence capable of supporting senior management in evaluating commercial performance, improving operational efficiency, and maximising profitability.

The interactive dashboard provides a comprehensive overview of key commercial performance indicators, including revenue generation, customer contribution, regional performance, product sales, salesperson productivity, shipping performance, and sales distribution across cities. These insights enable management to understand where revenue is generated, identify operational strengths and weaknesses, and prioritise future business investments.

The analysis reveals that the organisation generated approximately **$435,000 in total revenue**, sold over **20,600 units**, accumulated approximately **$43,700 in shipping fees**, and maintained an average unit price of approximately **$7,800**. While these figures indicate healthy commercial activity, the analysis also highlights that a significant proportion of revenue is concentrated among a relatively small number of customers, geographic locations, and sales representatives. This concentration presents both opportunities for growth and potential business risks if not proactively managed.

Beyond descriptive reporting, this project demonstrates how business intelligence contributes to commercial decision-making by connecting analytical findings with broader financial outcomes. Revenue performance directly influences profitability, operating cash flow, inventory management, customer relationship management, and shareholder value. The report therefore combines technical analysis with commercial interpretation to support data-driven business strategy.

From a professional perspective, this project demonstrates practical competencies in SQL querying, data transformation, Microsoft Advanced Excel, dashboard development, KPI reporting, commercial analytics, financial analysis, executive reporting, and business storytelling. These capabilities are directly applicable to modern Data Analyst, Business Intelligence Analyst, Commercial Analyst, Financial Analyst, Reporting Analyst, and Business Analyst roles across multinational organisations.

Business Context

Today's organisations operate in highly competitive and data-driven environments where commercial success depends on making timely, evidence-based decisions. Every customer transaction generates valuable information that can be used to improve pricing strategies, optimise inventory, enhance customer relationships, measure operational performance, and increase profitability.

Despite collecting large volumes of sales data, many organisations struggle to convert transactional information into actionable business insights. Decision-makers often face challenges such as identifying their most profitable customers, understanding regional performance differences, evaluating sales productivity, monitoring product demand, and measuring operational efficiency. Without effective analytics, these challenges can result in missed revenue opportunities, inefficient resource allocation, declining profitability, and poor strategic planning.

Business Intelligence bridges this gap by transforming raw transactional data into meaningful information that supports executive decision-making. Rather than relying on intuition alone, organisations can use analytics to identify emerging trends, evaluate business performance, detect operational risks, and make informed commercial decisions.

This project addresses these challenges by developing an interactive executive dashboard that analyses Frangle's commercial sales performance during 2014. Using SQL for data extraction and Microsoft Advanced Excel for data modelling and visualisation, the analysis delivers actionable insights across multiple dimensions of commercial performance, including:

- Revenue generation
- Customer contribution
- Product performance
- Regional sales analysis
- City-level sales performance
- Sales representative productivity
- Shipping performance
- Operational efficiency

In addition to evaluating historical performance, the project demonstrates how descriptive analytics can support future strategic planning. The findings provide management with practical recommendations that can improve customer retention, optimise inventory investment, strengthen regional expansion strategies, enhance sales productivity, and increase long-term profitability.

This project also illustrates the growing importance of combining technical analytics with commercial understanding. Effective business analysts must not only develop dashboards but also communicate the business implications of their findings in a manner that enables executives to make confident, data-driven decisions.

Strategic Project Objectives

The primary objective of this project was to develop an executive-level commercial intelligence solution capable of supporting strategic decision-making through data-driven analysis.

Specifically, the project aimed to:

- Analyse overall commercial sales performance using historical transactional data.
- Measure organisational revenue generation through executive KPI reporting.
- Identify the customers contributing the highest commercial value.
- Evaluate customer concentration and potential revenue dependency risks.
- Assess regional and city-level sales performance to identify growth opportunities.
- Measure salesperson productivity and identify high-performing representatives.
- Analyse product-level sales performance to support inventory and pricing decisions.
- Evaluate shipping company performance and logistics contribution.
- Develop an interactive Microsoft Advanced Excel dashboard for executive reporting.
- Translate analytical findings into strategic business recommendations.
- Explain how commercial performance influences organisational profitability, financial performance, and shareholder value.
- Demonstrate the application of SQL and Microsoft Advanced Excel in solving real-world commercial business problems.

Collectively, these objectives provide a comprehensive framework for evaluating commercial performance while demonstrating how business intelligence supports organisational growth and competitive advantage.

Executive Business Questions

The analysis was designed to answer several strategic business questions commonly faced by commercial organisations and executive leadership teams.

Revenue Performance

- How much revenue did the organisation generate during the reporting period?
- What does overall sales performance indicate about business growth?

Customer Analytics

- Which customers generate the greatest proportion of annual revenue?
- Is revenue concentrated among a relatively small number of customers?
- Does customer concentration expose the business to financial risk?
- Which customer segments should receive additional investment and retention initiatives?

Regional Performance

- Which geographic regions generate the strongest commercial performance?
- Which regions present the greatest opportunity for future expansion?
- Are there significant regional performance disparities requiring management attention?

City-Level Analysis
- Which cities contribute the highest proportion of company revenue?
- Which cities demonstrate underutilised market potential?
- How should future sales and marketing resources be allocated geographically?

Product Performance

- Which products generate the highest sales revenue?
- Which products should receive additional marketing investment?
- Which products require pricing or inventory review?

Salesperson Performance
- Which sales representatives consistently outperform organisational expectations?
- What operational practices contribute to superior sales performance?
- How can successful sales behaviours be replicated across the wider sales organisation?

Logistics Performance
- Which shipping provider contributes most effectively to commercial operations?
- Are logistics partnerships operating efficiently?
- What opportunities exist to improve delivery performance while reducing operating costs?

Executive Decision Support
- What are the primary drivers of commercial success?
- What operational risks require immediate management attention?
- Which strategic initiatives are most likely to improve future revenue growth, operational efficiency, and profitability?

Answering these questions enables executives to move beyond descriptive reporting and adopt a more strategic, evidence-based approach to commercial management.

Technology Stack

Technology	Business Purpose
Microsoft SQL Server	Storage and management of transactional sales data
SQL	Data extraction, filtering, aggregation, and querying
Microsoft Advanced Excel	Data modelling, business analysis, and dashboard development
Power Query (Excel)	Data cleaning, transformation, and preparation
Pivot Tables	KPI aggregation and multidimensional analysis
Pivot Charts	Executive visualisation and performance reporting
Excel Formulas & Functions	Business calculations, derived metrics, and analytical modelling
Conditional Formatting	Performance monitoring and trend identification
Interactive Slicers	Dynamic dashboard filtering and executive exploration
Business Intelligence Dashboard	Executive reporting and decision support

Project Methodology

This project followed a structured business intelligence workflow that transformed raw transactional sales data into meaningful executive insights.

Phase 1 — Business Understanding

The project commenced by identifying the primary commercial objectives and defining the business questions that management required the analysis to answer. Understanding these objectives ensured that the analysis remained focused on delivering practical value rather than producing descriptive statistics alone.

Phase 2 — Data Extraction

The required sales data was extracted from the relational database using Microsoft SQL Server. SQL queries were developed to retrieve relevant transactional information, including customer details, sales values, product information, geographic data, salesperson information, shipping details, and pricing variables.

Using SQL ensured efficient retrieval of clean, structured data suitable for downstream analysis.

```sql
-- EXTRACT: All columns listed explicitly
SELECT
    OrderID,
    OrderDate,
    CustomerID,
    CustomerName,
    Address,
    City,
    State,
    Zip/PostalCode,
    Country/Region,
    Salesperson,
    Region,
    ShippedDate,
```

Output

Action Output

#	Time	Action	Message

```sql
    ShipCity,
    ShipState,
    ShipZip/PostalCode,
    ShipCountry/Region,
    PaymentType,
    ProductName,
    Category,
    UnitPrice,
    Quantity,
    Revenue,
    ShippingFee
FROM `Frangles Sales Database`.`Sales Records`;
```

Output

Action Output

#	Time	Action	Message

Phase 3 — Data Preparation

Following extraction, the dataset was imported into Microsoft Advanced Excel where Power Query was used to prepare the data for analysis.

Preparation activities included:

- Data validation
- Data cleaning
- Handling missing values
- Removing duplicate records
- Standardising formats
- Creating calculated fields
- Ensuring data consistency

High-quality data preparation established a reliable analytical foundation and improved the accuracy of subsequent business insights.

Phase 4 — Data Analysis

Once prepared, the dataset was analysed using Microsoft Advanced Excel.

Multiple analytical techniques were applied to evaluate:

- Revenue performance
- Customer contribution
- Product sales
- Regional performance
- City performance
- Salesperson productivity
- Shipping performance
- Executive KPIs

This stage transformed raw data into measurable commercial intelligence capable of supporting executive decision-making.

Phase 5 — Dashboard Development
Interactive dashboards were designed using Pivot Tables, Pivot Charts, KPI cards, slicers, and advanced Excel features.

The dashboard enables decision-makers to explore business performance dynamically by filtering data across multiple commercial dimensions.

The interactive design improves accessibility while supporting rapid executive decision-making.

Phase 6 — Business Interpretation
Analytical outputs were interpreted from both commercial and financial perspectives.
Rather than reporting numerical findings alone, the analysis explains:
- Why observed trends occurred
- Their impact on business performance

- Associated commercial risks
- Opportunities for operational improvement
- Financial implications for the organisation

This approach transforms descriptive analytics into strategic business intelligence.

Phase 7 — Strategic Recommendations

Finally, analytical findings were translated into practical business recommendations designed to improve commercial performance.

Recommendations focus on:

- Revenue growth
- Customer diversification
- Regional expansion
- Inventory optimisation
- Sales productivity
- Logistics efficiency
- Profitability improvement
- Executive performance monitoring

By combining technical analysis with strategic business interpretation, the project demonstrates how modern business intelligence enables organisations to make confident, evidence-based decisions that support sustainable long-term growth.

Dashboard Overview

Executive Dashboard

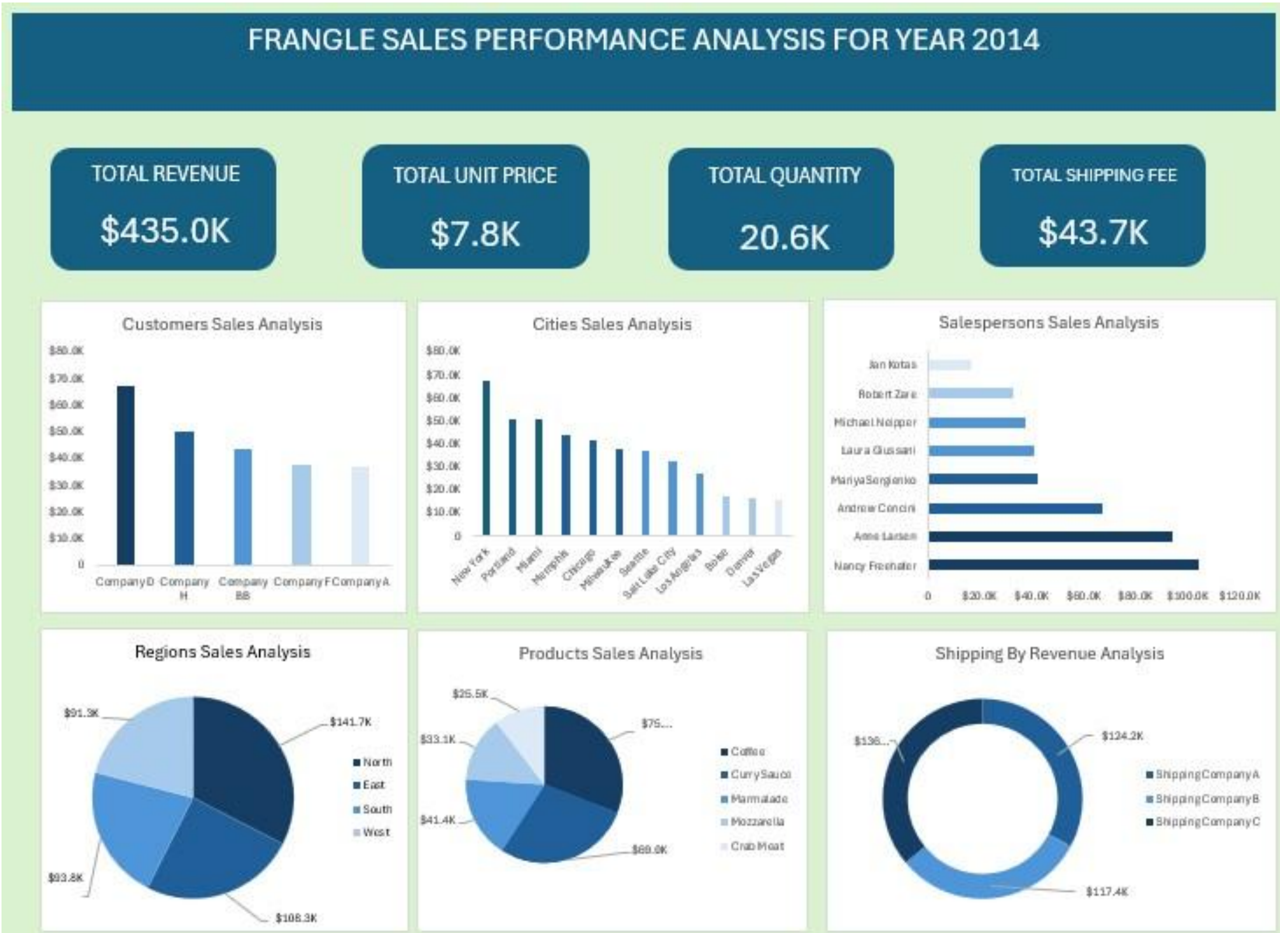
The Commercial Revenue & Sales Intelligence Dashboard was designed to provide senior management with an interactive, data-driven overview of organisational sales performance. Rather than presenting raw transactional records, the dashboard consolidates thousands of sales transactions into meaningful Key Performance Indicators (KPIs), enabling executives to evaluate commercial performance quickly and make informed strategic decisions.

Developed using **Microsoft Advanced Excel**, the dashboard combines Pivot Tables, Pivot Charts, KPI Cards, Conditional Formatting, Slicers, and interactive visualisations to present business performance from multiple perspectives. Decision-makers can dynamically filter data and explore relationships between customers, products, geographic markets, sales representatives, and logistics providers without manually querying the underlying dataset.

The dashboard supports executive decision-making by answering critical commercial questions, including:

- How much revenue has the organisation generated?
- Which customers contribute the highest commercial value?
- Which cities and regions drive business growth?
- Which products generate the strongest sales performance?
- Which sales representatives consistently outperform expectations?
- How efficiently are shipping operations supporting commercial activities?

By integrating these analytical dimensions into a single reporting interface, management can rapidly identify emerging trends, evaluate operational performance, prioritise investment opportunities, and monitor strategic objectives.



Executive KPI Analysis

The dashboard summarises commercial performance through four executive Key Performance Indicators (KPIs), each representing an important measure of organisational health and operational effectiveness.

These KPIs provide management with an immediate understanding of business performance while serving as the foundation for deeper analytical investigation.

Total Revenue

KPI Value: Approximately $435,000

Revenue represents the total value generated from commercial sales during the reporting period and serves as the organisation's primary performance indicator.

The dashboard indicates that the company generated approximately **$435,000** in sales revenue during 2014, demonstrating strong commercial activity across multiple customer segments and geographic markets.

Revenue growth is one of the most significant indicators of organisational performance because it directly influences profitability, cash generation, business expansion, and long-term shareholder value.

Business Interpretation
The reported revenue demonstrates that the organisation maintained healthy market demand throughout the reporting period. However, revenue alone does not guarantee sustainable growth. Management must also understand where revenue originates, which customers generate the highest commercial value, and whether current revenue patterns expose the business to concentration risks.

The subsequent analyses therefore investigate customer contribution, regional distribution, and sales performance to determine whether current revenue generation is balanced and sustainable.

Executive Insight
Revenue performance provides a positive indication of market demand; however, sustainable long-term growth requires continued customer diversification, regional expansion, and product portfolio optimisation.

Quantity Sold

KPI Value: Approximately 20,600 Units

Total quantity sold measures customer demand and overall market activity throughout the reporting period.

The dashboard indicates that more than **20,600 products** were sold during the year, demonstrating consistent purchasing activity across the company's customer base.

Business Interpretation

Sales volume provides valuable insight into customer purchasing behaviour and market acceptance of the organisation's products.

Strong unit sales generally indicate:
- Healthy customer demand
- Effective sales operations
- Appropriate pricing strategies
- Strong product-market alignment

Monitoring quantity sold alongside revenue also enables management to determine whether revenue growth is driven primarily by higher sales volumes, pricing improvements, or a combination of both.

Executive Insight

Maintaining strong sales volumes while simultaneously improving average selling prices presents an opportunity to increase overall profitability without relying solely on customer acquisition.

Shipping Fees

KPI Value: Approximately $43,700

Shipping fees represent the total logistics costs associated with fulfilling customer orders.

Although shipping charges often receive less executive attention than revenue, they significantly influence operating costs, customer satisfaction, and supply chain efficiency.

Business Interpretation

Efficient logistics directly contribute to improved customer experiences, faster order fulfilment, reduced operating expenses, and stronger competitive positioning.

Monitoring shipping performance enables management to:
- Evaluate logistics efficiency
- Compare shipping providers
- Control distribution costs
- Improve delivery performance

Executive Insight

Effective logistics management supports both revenue generation and customer retention. Continuous monitoring of shipping performance can reduce operating costs while improving service quality.

Average Unit Price

KPI Value: Approximately $7,800

Average unit price measures the average selling value of products throughout the reporting period.

This KPI provides valuable insight into pricing strategy, customer purchasing behaviour, and overall commercial positioning.

Business Interpretation

Maintaining healthy average selling prices indicates that the organisation successfully balances customer demand with pricing strategy.

Significant fluctuations in average selling price may indicate:
- Product mix changes
- Promotional pricing
- Market competition
- Customer purchasing behaviour
- Strategic pricing adjustments

Monitoring pricing trends enables management to maximise revenue while maintaining competitive market positioning.

Executive Insight

Effective pricing strategy remains one of the most important drivers of revenue growth and long-term profitability.

Revenue Performance Analysis

Revenue serves as the most important indicator of commercial success because it reflects the organisation's ability to generate income through customer transactions.

The dashboard indicates total commercial revenue of approximately **$435,000**, demonstrating that the organisation maintained healthy sales activity throughout the reporting period.

While the overall revenue performance is encouraging, executive decision-making requires understanding not only how much revenue was generated but also the underlying factors responsible for producing those results.

The dashboard reveals that revenue generation is not evenly distributed across customers, products, sales representatives, or geographic locations. Instead, a relatively small number of business segments contribute disproportionately to total revenue.

Business Interpretation

Revenue concentration presents both opportunities and risks.

High-performing customer segments represent valuable strategic assets that should receive continued investment through relationship management, customer retention initiatives, and personalised commercial engagement.

However, excessive dependence on a limited number of customers or markets increases business risk. The loss of major accounts could significantly reduce future revenue and negatively affect profitability.

Financial Perspective

Revenue growth directly affects multiple financial statement components:

- Higher revenue increases Gross Profit.
- Improved profitability contributes to higher Net Income.
- Increased earnings strengthen Retained Earnings within Shareholders' Equity.
- Strong revenue generation improves Operating Cash Flow.
- Sustainable revenue growth increases overall business valuation.

Strategic Recommendation
Management should continue expanding the customer base while reducing dependency on high-value accounts through targeted customer acquisition strategies and geographic market expansion.

Customer Performance Analysis
Customers represent the organisation's most valuable commercial assets, making customer analytics one of the most important components of executive reporting.

The dashboard identifies the organisation's highest-value customers and measures their contribution to overall revenue.

The analysis reveals that a relatively small number of customers contribute a substantial proportion of annual sales, demonstrating the well-known Pareto principle frequently observed in commercial organisations.

Business Interpretation

High-value customers generate significant commercial value and should receive priority attention through customer relationship management programmes, personalised service delivery, and long-term retention initiatives.

At the same time, customer concentration introduces operational and financial risks.

Should one or more major customers reduce purchasing activity or terminate commercial relationships, the organisation could experience immediate revenue declines.

Diversifying the customer portfolio therefore remains essential for long-term commercial stability.

Business Risk

Customer concentration may result in:
- Revenue volatility
- Increased commercial dependency
- Greater negotiation power for major customers
- Reduced pricing flexibility
- Higher business risk

Strategic Recommendation

Management should strengthen customer acquisition initiatives while maintaining strong engagement with existing high-value customers through proactive account management strategies.

Regional Performance Analysis

Regional analysis enables management to understand geographic sales performance and evaluate the effectiveness of commercial expansion strategies.

The dashboard compares sales revenue across multiple regions, allowing executives to identify both high-performing markets and regions with significant growth potential.

Differences in regional performance often reflect variations in:

- Customer demographics
- Market maturity
- Economic activity
- Sales coverage
- Competitive intensity

Business Interpretation

High-performing regions demonstrate strong market demand and should remain strategic priorities for future investment.

Conversely, lower-performing regions may require:
- Increased marketing activity
- Expanded sales coverage
- Product portfolio adjustments
- Improved customer engagement
- Localised promotional campaigns

Regional analytics enable management to allocate commercial resources more efficiently and maximise return on investment.

Strategic Recommendation

Future commercial expansion should prioritise regions demonstrating consistent revenue growth while implementing targeted improvement strategies within underperforming markets.

City Performance Analysis

City-level analysis provides a more detailed understanding of commercial performance than regional reporting alone.

The dashboard identifies the cities contributing the highest proportion of organisational revenue while highlighting geographic areas with untapped commercial potential.

City analysis enables management to optimise sales territory planning, resource allocation, marketing investment, and customer engagement strategies.

Business Interpretation

Cities generating consistently high revenue indicate strong customer demand, effective sales execution, and favourable market conditions.

These markets present opportunities for:
- Business expansion
- Additional product offerings
- Increased marketing investment
- Enhanced customer relationship programmes

Lower-performing cities should not necessarily be viewed as unsuccessful markets. Instead, they may represent emerging commercial opportunities requiring improved market penetration strategies.

Financial Perspective

Successful expansion into high-growth cities can contribute to:
- Higher revenue growth
- Increased operating profit

- Improved asset utilisation
- Stronger long-term cash flow
- Enhanced shareholder value

Strategic Recommendation

Management should continue investing in high-performing cities while conducting market research within underperforming locations to identify barriers limiting commercial growth and develop targeted expansion initiatives.

Product Performance Analysis

Product performance analysis evaluates the contribution of individual products to overall organisational revenue and provides management with valuable insights into customer purchasing behaviour, inventory effectiveness, pricing strategy, and commercial profitability.

Understanding which products consistently generate the highest revenue enables executives to optimise inventory investment, improve marketing strategies, strengthen supplier relationships, and maximise return on commercial resources.

The dashboard highlights clear differences in product performance, demonstrating that a relatively small number of products contribute a significant proportion of total sales revenue. This pattern is common in retail and commercial organisations where high-demand products become the primary drivers of revenue generation.

Business Interpretation

High-performing products represent the organisation's strongest commercial assets and should receive continued strategic attention.

Products generating consistently high revenue indicate:
- Strong customer demand
- Effective pricing strategy
- Healthy inventory turnover
- Successful product-market fit
- Positive contribution to overall profitability

Conversely, products with relatively low sales performance should not automatically be discontinued. Instead, management should investigate the underlying reasons for weaker performance, including pricing, customer awareness, market competition, inventory availability, seasonal demand, or sales promotion effectiveness.

Effective product portfolio management enables organisations to balance high-volume products with niche offerings while maintaining profitability and customer satisfaction.

Operational Impact

Continuous product performance monitoring enables management to:
- Optimise inventory replenishment
- Improve demand forecasting

- Reduce inventory carrying costs
- Minimise obsolete inventory
- Improve procurement planning
- Increase warehouse efficiency
- Support strategic pricing decisions

Financial Perspective

Strong-performing products contribute directly to several key financial outcomes.

Income Statement

High product sales increase:
- Revenue
- Gross Profit
- Operating Profit
- Net Profit

Balance Sheet

Effective inventory management improves:
- Inventory Turnover
- Current Assets utilisation
- Cash Availability
- Working Capital Efficiency

Cash Flow Statement

Products with strong sales velocity generate faster cash conversion, improving Operating Cash Flow and reducing capital tied up in inventory.

Executive Recommendation

Management should continue investing in products demonstrating consistent commercial success while conducting periodic profitability analysis to ensure product margins remain attractive.

Lower-performing products should undergo detailed review to determine whether improved pricing strategies, targeted marketing campaigns, or inventory optimisation can improve commercial performance.

Salesperson Performance Analysis

Sales representatives play a critical role in revenue generation and customer relationship management.

The dashboard evaluates individual salesperson performance by measuring sales revenue generated across the reporting period.

Performance differences among sales representatives provide valuable insights into sales effectiveness, customer engagement strategies, territory management, and commercial execution.

The analysis demonstrates that certain sales representatives consistently outperform their colleagues, indicating the existence of highly effective selling practices that could potentially be replicated across the wider sales organisation.

Business Interpretation

High-performing sales representatives contribute substantially to organisational growth through:
- Strong customer relationship management
- Effective negotiation skills
- Product knowledge
- Market understanding
- Customer retention
- Cross-selling opportunities

Rather than viewing top performers simply as successful employees, management should consider them valuable organisational resources whose sales methodologies can be documented and shared across the wider sales team.

Equally important is identifying representatives whose performance falls below expectations and providing targeted coaching, mentoring, or additional product training.

Operational Impact

Performance monitoring enables management to:
- Improve sales coaching
- Identify training needs
- Allocate sales territories more effectively
- Establish performance benchmarks
- Improve workforce productivity
- Increase customer satisfaction

Sales analytics also supports fair performance evaluation by enabling objective, data-driven performance measurement rather than relying solely on subjective managerial assessment.

Financial Perspective

Higher salesperson productivity contributes directly to:

Income Statement

- Increased Revenue
- Higher Gross Profit
- Improved Operating Profit

Balance Sheet

Sustained revenue growth strengthens:
- Cash balances
- Accounts Receivable quality

- Retained Earnings
- Shareholders' Equity

Cash Flow Statement

Improved sales productivity generates stronger operating cash inflows, supporting future business investment and expansion.

Executive Recommendation

Management should establish a formal sales performance programme that identifies best-performing representatives, documents successful sales practices, and implements structured coaching initiatives to improve organisation-wide sales effectiveness.

Introducing performance-based incentives aligned with measurable KPIs may further enhance employee motivation and commercial productivity.

Shipping Performance Analysis

Logistics performance represents an essential component of commercial operations because customer satisfaction depends not only on product quality but also on efficient order fulfilment and reliable delivery services.

The dashboard compares shipping providers to evaluate logistics performance across the reporting period.

Although shipping costs represent only one component of operating expenses, inefficient logistics can significantly reduce profitability through delayed deliveries, increased transportation costs, damaged products, and declining customer satisfaction.

Business Interpretation

Shipping analysis enables management to evaluate:
- Delivery efficiency
- Distribution effectiveness
- Logistics reliability
- Cost management
- Customer service quality

High-performing shipping providers contribute positively to customer experience by delivering products accurately and promptly.

Conversely, poor logistics performance may result in:

- Customer complaints
- Increased operational costs
- Lost sales opportunities
- Lower customer retention
- Brand reputation damage

Shipping analytics therefore extends beyond cost management and becomes an important driver of long-term commercial success.

Operational Impact

Effective logistics management improves:
- Order fulfilment
- Warehouse operations
- Distribution planning
- Inventory availability
- Customer satisfaction
- Supply chain resilience

Regular monitoring of shipping performance enables management to negotiate improved service agreements while identifying opportunities for operational cost reduction.

Financial Perspective

Efficient logistics contributes to:

Income Statement

- Reduced Operating Expenses
- Higher Operating Profit
- Improved Net Profit Margin

Balance Sheet

Efficient distribution improves:
- Inventory Turnover
- Working Capital Management
- Current Asset Utilisation

Cash Flow Statement

Lower logistics costs increase Operating Cash Flow and improve the organisation's ability to finance future expansion.

Executive Recommendation

Management should regularly evaluate logistics providers using performance metrics such as delivery time, shipping cost, order accuracy, customer satisfaction, and service reliability.

Long-term logistics partnerships should be based on measurable performance indicators rather than transportation cost alone.

Business Impact Assessment

The findings generated from this analysis extend beyond operational reporting and provide strategic insights capable of influencing executive decision-making across multiple business functions.

The dashboard demonstrates that commercial analytics enables organisations to move from reactive decision-making toward proactive business management by identifying performance drivers, operational risks, and future growth opportunities.

Several important commercial observations emerge from the analysis:

- Revenue generation remains healthy, demonstrating strong customer demand.
- Commercial performance is concentrated among a relatively small number of customers and products.
- Geographic performance varies significantly across regions and cities.
- Individual salesperson productivity differs considerably, indicating opportunities for performance improvement.
- Product demand is unevenly distributed across the portfolio.
- Logistics performance directly influences both customer satisfaction and operating efficiency.

Collectively, these findings provide management with evidence-based insights capable of supporting strategic planning, operational optimisation, and long-term business growth.

Rather than relying on intuition, executives can use these analytical outputs to prioritise investments, allocate commercial resources efficiently, strengthen customer relationships, improve operational performance, and maximise shareholder value.

The project therefore illustrates how Business Intelligence supports sustainable competitive advantage by transforming historical sales data into actionable commercial knowledge.

Financial & Accounting Perspective

One of the distinguishing features of this project is the integration of commercial analytics with financial and accounting principles.

While dashboards often focus exclusively on operational KPIs, business leaders require a broader understanding of how commercial performance ultimately affects organisational financial health.

By combining data analytics with accounting knowledge, this project demonstrates how commercial activities influence the three primary financial statements.

Impact on the Income Statement

Commercial performance directly determines the organisation's financial results.

Strong sales performance contributes to:

- Increased Revenue
- Higher Gross Profit
- Improved Operating Profit
- Greater Net Profit

Conversely, declining sales, inefficient logistics, poor inventory management, or ineffective sales execution reduce organisational profitability.

Management therefore benefits from continuously monitoring commercial KPIs to protect earnings performance.

Impact on the Balance Sheet

Commercial decisions influence multiple Balance Sheet accounts.

Current Assets

Strong sales improve:
- Cash
- Accounts Receivable
- Inventory utilisation

Inventory

High-performing products improve inventory turnover while reducing excess stockholding and carrying costs.

Working Capital

Efficient sales operations strengthen liquidity through faster inventory conversion and improved receivable collection.

Shareholders' Equity

Higher profitability increases retained earnings, strengthening shareholders' equity and improving the organisation's long-term financial position.

Impact on the Cash Flow Statement

Commercial performance also affects cash generation.

Healthy sales activity produces stronger operating cash inflows, enabling the organisation to:
- Finance future growth
- Invest in technology
- Expand operations
- Improve infrastructure
- Reduce borrowing requirements

Conversely, poor inventory management, declining sales, or ineffective receivable collection may create cash flow pressures despite reporting accounting profits.

For this reason, executives should evaluate commercial performance alongside profitability and cash generation rather than relying on revenue figures alone.

Business Intelligence Value

This project demonstrates that modern Data Analysts create value beyond dashboard development.

By combining SQL, Microsoft Advanced Excel, business analysis, commercial intelligence, and accounting knowledge, analytical findings become strategic assets capable of supporting executive decision-making.

Rather than answering only **"What happened?,** this project also addresses:

- **Why did it happen?**
- **What risks exist?**
- **What financial impact does it create?**
- **What actions should management take next?**

This transition from descriptive reporting to strategic decision support reflects the evolving role of Business Intelligence within modern organisations and demonstrates the analytical capabilities expected of Data Analysts working within multinational organisations, financial institutions, consulting firms, and technology companies.

Strategic Recommendations

The findings from this Commercial Revenue & Sales Intelligence analysis provide several opportunities for management to strengthen business performance, improve operational efficiency, and support sustainable long-term growth.

Rather than relying solely on historical reporting, the analytical insights generated through this project can be leveraged to guide strategic decision-making across sales, finance, operations, inventory management, and customer relationship management.

The following recommendations are based on the observed sales patterns, customer behaviour, regional performance, product demand, and operational metrics presented throughout this analysis.

1. Diversify the Customer Base

The analysis indicates that a relatively small number of customers contribute a significant proportion of total sales revenue.

Although high-value customers are essential to business success, excessive dependence on a limited customer base exposes the organisation to commercial risk.

Should one or more major customers reduce purchasing activity or terminate business relationships, overall revenue and profitability could decline significantly.

Recommended Actions

- Develop targeted customer acquisition strategies.
- Expand marketing activities into new customer segments.
- Increase customer retention initiatives.
- Introduce customer loyalty programmes.
- Strengthen customer relationship management using data-driven insights.

Expected Business Benefits

- Reduced customer concentration risk
- Improved revenue stability
- Sustainable long-term growth
- Increased market share

2. Invest in High-Growth Geographic Markets
Regional and city-level analysis demonstrates noticeable differences in commercial performance.

Rather than allocating resources equally across all markets, management should prioritise investment within regions demonstrating consistent revenue growth while developing targeted improvement plans for underperforming locations.

Recommended Actions

- Increase marketing investment within high-performing regions.
- Expand sales coverage into emerging markets.
- Conduct local market research within low-performing cities.
- Introduce region-specific promotional campaigns.
- Optimise sales territory planning.

Expected Business Benefits

- Increased regional market penetration
- Improved sales productivity
- Higher revenue growth
- Better return on marketing investment

3. Optimise Product Portfolio Performance

Not all products contribute equally to organisational revenue.

The analysis demonstrates that several products consistently outperform others, suggesting opportunities to improve inventory investment and pricing strategies.

Recommended Actions

- Increase inventory availability for high-demand products.
- Review pricing strategies for underperforming products.
- Conduct profitability analysis at product level.
- Remove or redesign consistently unprofitable products where appropriate.
- Introduce demand forecasting models to improve inventory planning.

Expected Business Benefits

- Improved inventory turnover
- Reduced carrying costs
- Increased gross profit
- Higher customer satisfaction
- Better product availability

4. Strengthen Sales Performance Management

Sales representatives contribute directly to organisational revenue generation.

The dashboard demonstrates measurable differences in salesperson performance, providing management with valuable opportunities to improve overall commercial effectiveness.

Recommended Actions

- Establish sales performance scorecards.
- Introduce KPI-driven performance reviews.
- Document best practices from top-performing representatives.
- Expand coaching and mentoring programmes.
- Align performance incentives with measurable business objectives.

Expected Business Benefits

- Higher sales productivity
- Improved employee engagement
- Better customer service
- Increased revenue generation

5. Improve Logistics and Distribution Efficiency

Shipping performance influences customer satisfaction, operational efficiency, and operating expenses.

Monitoring logistics performance enables management to optimise distribution while reducing unnecessary transportation costs.

Recommended Actions

- Regularly evaluate shipping providers using measurable KPIs.
- Monitor delivery performance.
- Reduce shipping delays.
- Improve warehouse coordination.
- Strengthen supply chain planning.

Expected Business Benefits

- Lower operating expenses
- Faster order fulfilment
- Improved customer satisfaction
- Increased customer retention

6. Develop Executive Performance Dashboards

Business Intelligence should become a continuous management capability rather than a one-time analytical exercise.

Interactive dashboards allow executives to monitor business performance in real time and make faster, evidence-based decisions.

Recommended Actions

Develop executive dashboards covering:
- Revenue
- Profitability
- Customer KPIs
- Sales performance
- Inventory
- Regional performance
- Cash Flow
- Operational efficiency

Expected Business Benefits

- Faster decision-making
- Improved organisational visibility
- Increased operational transparency
- Better strategic planning

7. Build a Data-Driven Business Culture

One of the most valuable long-term investments an organisation can make is embedding analytics into everyday decision-making.

Departments such as Finance, Sales, Operations, Marketing, Customer Service, Procurement, and Executive Leadership should all leverage business intelligence to improve organisational performance.

Recommended Actions

- Promote data-driven decision-making across departments.
- Standardise KPI reporting.
- Encourage cross-functional collaboration.
- Improve data governance practices.
- Expand analytical capability within the organisation.

Expected Business Benefits

- Better business decisions
- Increased organisational agility
- Improved profitability
- Sustainable competitive advantage

Skills Demonstrated

This project demonstrates a broad range of technical, analytical, financial, and business competencies expected of modern Data Analysts and Business Intelligence professionals working within multinational organisations.

Data Analysis

- Commercial Data Analysis

- Sales Performance Analysis
- Customer Analytics
- Product Performance Analysis
- Geographic Analysis
- Trend Analysis
- KPI Reporting
- Business Intelligence

SQL

- Data Extraction
- Data Querying
- Data Filtering
- Aggregation
- Joins
- Sorting
- Business Reporting
- Data Validation

Microsoft Advanced Excel

- Pivot Tables
- Pivot Charts
- Power Query
- Interactive Dashboards
- Conditional Formatting
- Data Cleaning
- Data Modelling
- Advanced Formulas
- Executive Reporting

Business Intelligence

- Dashboard Development
- KPI Design
- Executive Reporting
- Business Storytelling
- Decision Support
- Performance Measurement

Financial & Commercial Analysis

- Revenue Analysis
- Profitability Analysis
- Customer Value Analysis
- Inventory Performance
- Commercial Intelligence
- Business Performance Evaluation
- Financial Interpretation
- Operational Analysis

Business Skills

- Problem Solving
- Critical Thinking
- Strategic Analysis
- Stakeholder Communication
- Data Storytelling
- Business Process Improvement
- Decision Support
- Executive Presentation

Why This Project Matters

Modern organisations generate enormous quantities of transactional data every day.

The true value of this data lies not in its volume but in the ability to convert it into meaningful insights that support informed decision-making.

This project demonstrates how Business Intelligence can bridge the gap between operational data and executive strategy.

Rather than simply producing reports, the analysis transforms raw sales transactions into actionable commercial intelligence capable of improving revenue growth, operational efficiency, customer satisfaction, and organisational profitability.

The project reflects real-world analytical responsibilities commonly performed by Data Analysts, Business Analysts, Commercial Analysts, Financial Analysts, Reporting Analysts, and Business Intelligence professionals across industries including retail, financial services, healthcare, consulting, technology, logistics, and manufacturing.

It demonstrates the ability to combine technical analytics with commercial understanding, ensuring that business leaders receive insights that are both accurate and strategically valuable.

About the Author

Dayo Rex Afariogun

Senior Business Analyst | Financial Data Analytics & Business Intelligence

Dayo Rex Afariogun is a Senior Business Analyst & Financial Data Analytics professional with over 14 years of business leadership experience, combining a strong foundation in Accounting with practical expertise in SQL, Python, Microsoft Advanced Excel, and Power BI.

His professional focus is transforming raw business data into actionable insights that improve decision-making, operational performance, financial management, and organisational growth.

His portfolio spans multiple analytical domains, including:

- Commercial Revenue & Sales Intelligence
- Credit Risk Assessment

- Loan Risk & Audit Analytics
- Healthcare Insurance Cost Analysis
- Retail Sales Analytics
- Business Intelligence Dashboards
- Financial Analytics
- Executive Reporting

Dayo is passionate about applying data analytics to solve real-world business problems and create measurable value for organisations through evidence-based decision-making.

He is currently seeking opportunities as a:

- Data Analyst
- Business Intelligence Analyst
- Business Analyst
- Commercial Analyst
- Financial Analyst
- Reporting Analyst

with multinational organisations where he can contribute analytical expertise, commercial insight, and strategic business thinking.

Executive Conclusion

This Commercial Revenue & Sales Intelligence project demonstrates the complete lifecycle of modern business analytics, from data extraction and preparation to executive reporting and strategic decision support.

Using **Microsoft SQL Server** for data extraction and **Microsoft Advanced Excel** for data analysis, modelling, visualisation, and dashboard development, the project illustrates how transactional sales data can be transformed into meaningful business intelligence that supports executive decision-making.

The analysis identified key drivers of commercial performance, including customer contribution, product demand, regional sales distribution, salesperson productivity, and logistics performance. Beyond presenting descriptive statistics, the project translated these findings into strategic recommendations capable of improving revenue growth, operational efficiency, customer retention, inventory optimisation, and long-term profitability.

By integrating business analysis with financial and accounting principles, the project demonstrates how commercial performance affects organisational financial health through its impact on revenue, profitability, working capital, cash flow, and shareholders' equity.

From a professional perspective, this portfolio project showcases competencies in SQL, Microsoft Advanced Excel, business intelligence, dashboard development, commercial analytics, financial analysis, executive reporting, and data storytelling—skills that are highly valued by multinational organisations, consulting firms, financial institutions, and technology companies.

Ultimately, this project reinforces the principle that successful organisations do not compete solely on the quantity of data they possess but on their ability to transform that data into actionable insights that drive better decisions, improve operational performance, and create sustainable business value.

Repository Information

Project: Commercial Revenue & Sales Intelligence

Prepared By: Dayo Rex Afariogun

Role: Senior Business Analyst | Financial Data Analytics & Business Intelligence

Tools Used:
- Microsoft SQL Server
- SQL
- Microsoft Advanced Excel
- Power Query
- Pivot Tables
- Pivot Charts
- Business Intelligence Dashboard

Project Type: Commercial Analytics | Sales Performance Analysis | Business Intelligence | Executive Dashboard | Financial Analysis

GitHub Repository:
https://github.com/dayo-data-analyst/Commercial-Revenue-Sales-Intelligence

Thank you for taking the time to review this project. I welcome opportunities to discuss how data analytics, business intelligence, and financial analysis can help organisations make smarter, evidence-based decisions and drive sustainable business growth.